



The cabinet meeting held on 26th February 2024 made a decision to declare the 3rd November 2023 Jajarkot earthquake affected municipal level as disaster emergency area.

Photo: From Archive

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- I. Stakeholders discussed managing forest fires in the Disaster Dialogue series
- II. Task force developed report on integrated information system for emergency services
- III. Discussion workshop on the Framework for Multi-Hazard Risk Assessment
- IV. Charting Paths to Global Justice: Reflections from the 16th World Social Forum in Kathmandu
- V. Advancing sustainability in the context of climate change through IPBES nexus assessment
- VI. Advancing Earthquake Risk Reduction: Insights from Nepal's National Symposium
- VII. Training held on Multi-hazard Risk Assessment for Risk Reduction Planning

CASE STORIES ON TEMPORARY SHELTER CONSTRUCTION

Dal Bahadur Pun's journey from earthquake devastation to hopeful reconstruction

Dal Bahadur Pun, a 67-year-old resident of Kalpath, Nalgadh Municipality-1, Jajarkot district lives with his wife. His son's family lives separately. They faced significant challenges after his home was severely damaged by an earthquake that injured his wife. Initially, the family sought refuge alongside neighbors. Later they were provided tarpaulin sheets as shelter support by humanitarian organizations and the government agencies. They also received various non-food items (NFI) support. Dal Bahadur Pun was enlisted as earthquake affected beneficiary by the Ward office. He was then enrolled as the temporary shelter construction beneficiary after NDRRMA released the temporary shelter construction guideline



and successfully became a recipient of the first tranche of a NDRRMA's government housing grant for constructing temporary shelter. He utilized a grant amount in purchasing some CGI sheets and timber, while the rest were salvaged from the damaged house. His family has transitioned to the newly constructed temporary shelter. Elated with the government grant to construct temporary shelter, he eagerly awaits the final tranche. He plans to allocate the grant towards settling the borrowed amount incurred during the construction of the temporary shelter and also awaits further grant support from the government for reconstructing the new house.

NATIONAL UPDATES

Stakeholders discussed managing forest fires in the Disaster Dialogue series

A Disaster Dialogue series on possibilities of Forest-Fire Risk in 2024 fire season, its consequences and measures of reduction and management was conducted by NDRRMA on 27th February. Experts focus on preparedness including the mass public awareness campaigns at core Ward level (local), training on fire-control to frontliners, arrangements of fire-fighting equipment for local communities and collaboration among the stakeholders for the forest fire risk reduction & management, as mitigation measures at the 'Disaster Dialogue' organized at NDRRMA.



Mr. Sunder Prasad Sharma, Under Secretary and Fire Expert of NDRRMA gave a presentation and informed that more than 64 percent of fire incidents in Nepal are due to human negligence. Experts shared that the general public, as well as agencies concerned, should be cautious, as forest fires not only destroy forests but also pose a serious threat to humans and other beings and property. Source: [#ForestFire disaster dialogue Sharing on forest-fire pptx Forest fire information Disaster Dialogue covered by Surakshit Nepal TV program](#)

Task force developed a report on integrated information system for emergency services

A document on Integrated Information Emergency Response System (IERS) was submitted to the Ministry of Home Affairs on 29th February by a 11-member task force committee. This report highlights the need of single emergency number practice for emergency services as used in European, American and some Asian countries. The report also suggests the emergency framework that is to be established for effectiveness and smooth functioning of the overall IERS. This task force was formed by NDRRMA with the aim of creating an IERS that is capable of promptly relaying emergency texts sent by individuals through mobile or landline phones to a proposed central information hub for swift response in providing emergency services. According to the NDRRMA, the system will ensure facilities such as ambulance,



firefighting, police, and primary health services during emergencies in an integrated way. The information received at the central information system would be forwarded to the concerned body immediately. Source: [Task force for the integrated information systems](#)

Discussion workshop on the Framework for Multi-Hazard Risk Assessment

A workshop on development of the National Framework for Multi-Hazard Risk Assessment (MHRA) was organized on 11th February in Kathmandu. NDRRMA with support from MDTF funding agencies are developing a multi hazard assessment framework. The objective of the workshop was to discuss the draft Multi-hazard Risk Assessment (MHRA) Framework for Nepal. Specifically, the workshop aimed to: i) To present the MHRA methodology for Nepal covering floods, landslides, earthquakes, and forest fires to generate multi-hazard risk information systematically at different geographic scales and sectors, and ii) To discuss an MHRA framework to provide a guideline that identifies the various approaches for multi-hazard risk assessment that are suited for different levels of governments, different applications, and different situations of data availability. Vigorous discussions were held in the workshop where the stakeholders of governments, as well as academic, research, and technical institutions were engaged to review the national methodology and framework developed for MHRA. Source: [Concept note on MHRA](#)



Charting Paths to Global Justice: Reflections from the 16th World Social Forum in Kathmandu

The 16th edition of the World Social Forum (WSF) 2024 was organized in Kathmandu, Nepal from 15th -19th February 2024 to discuss the negative consequences of policies and structures adopted by the existing world systems. The event steered with a theme 'Another World is Possible', spanned over five-day event, attended by 50,000 participants from more than 1400 organizations spanning 98 countries, virtually and in-person at various concurrent events, as reported by the Nepal Organizing Committee of the WSF 2024. The series of panel sessions focused on topics such as "climate justice and environmental sustainability", "economic inequality and the global financial system", "labour rights and migration", "peace, justice and human rights" and "indigenous peoples' rights and cultural preservation". The event concluded with 60 declarations from organizations worldwide pledging to



collaborate towards the realization of another, fairer, and more just world, noted the Committee.
Source: [WSF2024Nepal](#) [WSF concludes in Kathmandu](#)

Advancing sustainability in the context of climate change through IPBES nexus assessment

The meeting on Intergovernmental Science-Policy Platform on Biodiversity and Ecosystem Services (IPBES) nexus assessment was held from 5th-9th February 2024, followed by a meeting to advance a summary for policymakers from 10th-11th February. The meetings were hosted by the Ministry of Environment and Forests/Government of Nepal, and the ICIMOD at its headquarters in Kathmandu. The IPBES is an independent intergovernmental body, with 145 member states, established to strengthen the science-policy interface for biodiversity and ecosystem services.



The overall aim of the nexus assessment is to facilitate enhanced understanding of the complex and dynamic interrelationships between biodiversity, water, food, and health, in the context of climate change, and to identify options to improve policies and foster greater understanding and collaboration across the nexus-related sectors. Over 130 leading scientists and subject experts from 70 countries assembled in Kathmandu, Nepal for the third author meeting of the IPBES nexus assessment, which has examined the interlinkages among the sustainable development goals related to food and water security, health for all, protecting biodiversity, and combating climate change. Source: [Over 130 global experts in Kathmandu for IPBES nexus assessment](#) [Examining the interlinkages among sustainable development goals](#)

Advancing Earthquake Risk Reduction: Insights from Nepal's National Symposium

The National Symposium on "Earthquake Risk Reduction and Management in Nepal," was organized in Kathmandu on February 1, 2024, in observance of the 26th National Earthquake Safety Day (ESD) which is a sharing and learning forum for the DRR stakeholders to review the DRR efforts of past years and discourse and explore the way forward in Earthquake Risk Management. Experts and professionals have emphasized the need for more collaborative efforts in disaster risk reduction and management initiatives to address challenges posed by various phenomena such as pandemics, climate change, and recurring earthquakes in Nepal. In the Symposium this year, a total three thematic sessions were organized: i) Jajarkot Earthquake Response and Relief, ii) Studies on Earthquake Damage and Impacts, and iii) Earthquake Recovery and Reconstruction. The DUDBC and NSET in association with various



government and non-governmental organizations organized this year's symposium. [Detail source: 26th National Symposium](#)

Training held on Multi-hazard Risk Assessment for Risk Reduction Planning

A training on "Multi-hazard Risk Assessment for Risk Reduction Planning" was successfully conducted from 12th-15th February in Kathmandu, in order to equip the capacities of the government officials from ministries and departments responsible for disaster risk management in Nepal. 'Asian and Pacific Training Centre for Information and Communication Technology for Development (APCICT)' in partnership with the 'Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific (ESCAP)' and 'United Nations Platform for Space-based Information for Disaster Management and Emergency Response (UN-SPIDER)' and NDRRMA and in collaboration with the Geoinformatics Center/Asian Institute of Technology and ITC-University of Twente, MHRA training was organized at the Institute of Engineering (IoE) of Tribhuvan University, Pulchowk Campus. Source: [Concept note of the training](#)



PARTNERS' UPDATES

Workshop on earthquake hazard assessment and aftershock forecasting

As continuation of the effort to impart knowledge on seismic hazard in Nepal and the possible risk reduction measures, NSET in collaboration with US Geological Survey (USGS) with funding support from USAID/Bureau for Humanitarian Assistance (BHA) have completed organizing a 3-day workshop on "Earthquake Hazard Assessment and Aftershock Forecasting" during 27th-29th February. Jointly in collaboration with Earthquake Safety Solutions (ESS) and under the guidance of Department of Mines and Geology (DMG) and NDRRMA/Government of Nepal, the workshop overall aimed to enhance the capacity in earthquake hazard assessment in Nepal and to work towards establishment of collaborative system for regular discussion and consensus processes



National Housing and Settlements Resilience Platform, Nepal

on seismic hazard evaluation among seismic hazard and earthquake engineering professionals. The workshop covered some key topics such as forecasting future seismic risk, aftershocks forecasting and collection of seismic data. Senior and young professionals working towards technical seismic hazard studies in Nepal were the participants of the workshop. Detail sources: [Concept note of the workshop](#) [Workshop Schedule](#)

IFRC, WWF call for global action to protect nature to save lives and address climate crisis

In the face of escalating climate change impacts and an increase in weather-related disasters which Particularly affecting developing countries like Nepal, the IFRC and the WWF have come together to leverage nature-based solutions to address the climate emergency. Following the global partnership, the IFRC and WWF in Nepal are launching a strategic partnership today with the theme "Working with Nature to Protect People."



This joint initiative recognizes the critical role of nature-based solutions in both mitigating and adapting to climate change while fostering resilience among communities on the front lines of the crisis. In Nepal, the partnership between IFRC and WWF will leverage their combined expertise and extensive networks to address the ongoing climate crisis, emerging risks, and societal challenges. Through local action and collaboration with government, partners, development agencies, donors, and private sectors, IFRC and WWF aim to integrate nature into climate adaptation strategies. This also includes engagement with authorities at all levels to provide policy advice and coordinate the initiatives as part of wider humanitarian and development efforts. Nature-based solutions, such as forest restoration, water source management, wetland rehabilitation, and river-bank plantations, have proven effective in Nepal, offering benefits beyond disaster risk reduction. Source: [Working with nature to protect people](#)

Safe housing, improved water access, and bolstering community resilience in Lamjung

A significant milestone is achieved by Lamjung Recovery Project (LRP), led by CRS Nepal and implementing local partner, Rural Community Development Center (RCDC), by reconstructing a total of 50 houses for earthquake-affected people. Along with this, the project supported beneficiaries spread across Marsyangdi Rural Municipality and Besisahar Municipality with livelihood and agricultural inputs, rehabilitation of water schemes such as irrigation canals, construction of drinking water taps, installation of water pipes etc.



Furthermore, the project marked another significant achievement with the development of DRR strategic plan and mitigation measures to reduce prevalent risks, ensuring a more sustainable and resilient future for the at-risk communities in Marsyangdi Rural Municipality, Dordi Rural Municipality, Sundarbazar Municipality and Besisahar Municipality of Lamjung district. This project became a reality, providing safe housing, improved water access, and bolstering community resilience post the 5.8 magnitude earthquake in May 2021 that hit Lamjung district. These project supports were handed over to the individuals and communities through organizing social audit programs in the presence of local officials in Marsyangdi Rural Municipality and Besisahar Municipality. For more information: krishna.joshi@crs.org

Jajakot Emergency Response Project

Led by CRS Nepal with technical support from Caritas Nepal, Jajarkot Emergency Response Project (JERP) has completed the construction of more than 100 most vulnerable participants affected by the Jajarkot earthquake in Jajarkot and Rukum West districts. The construction follows NDRRMA's guidelines ensuring safe, dignified and locally appropriate shelter solutions. Most housing units include 2 bedrooms, 1 kitchen and veranda, and some include a greater number of rooms depending on family size. CRS plans to extend this support to 600 additional families in coordination with NDRRMA and local governments. Going forward CRS in coordination with NHSRP will prioritize the delivery of socio-technical assistance, supporting 1500 additional families to access and utilize Government of Nepal's financial support for temporary shelter towards transitional shelter construction. For more information: arun.sharma@crs.org



Launching of resources on energy efficiency building designs

The BUILDING Energy Efficiency in Nepal (BEEN) Project launched pivotal resources aimed at transforming Nepal's building sector into energy efficiency with: i) Baseline Report on Operational Energy Consumption in Buildings in Nepal and ii) Manual for Energy-Efficient Building Design. These resources set the foundation for understanding current energy usage and outlines paths towards sustainability while the Manual aims to guide for integrating energy efficiency into building designs, ensuring our structures provide thermal comfort, are sustainable & environment friendly. Additionally, 'Energy Efficiency By Laws 2080' was launched in Pokhara Metropolitan City and Dhulikhel Municipality, done in collaboration



through the EU under the Switch Asia Grant Program implemented by MinErgy. Together, these initiatives signify a transformative step towards reducing our carbon footprint and embracing comfort that values sustainability at its core. For more information: suyesh.prajapati@minergynepal.com

Habitat Young Leaders Build (HYLB) campaign in Bheri Municipality

Habitat Young Leaders Build (HYLB) campaign was successfully conducted in Ward no 1, Bheri Municipality, Jajarkot district from 13th -15th February. In coordination with DAO Jajarkot, the campaign was led by Habitat for Humanity Nepal (HfH) through implementing partner, NEEDs Nepal. The local youth volunteers have established a loose forum to collaborate with Bheri Municipality, enhancing the volunteering efforts in a region that is still recovering from the 6.4 magnitude earthquake on 3rd November 2023. The capacities of a total of 30 young volunteers were enhanced through the HYLB campaign, which reflects the collective efforts, dedicated volunteerism and commitment of all stakeholders involved towards rebuilding earthquake-affected communities and enhancing their resilience for the future. For more information: rbasnet@habitatnepal.org



NHSRP's PROVINCIAL ENGAGEMENTS

UPDATES FROM BAGMATI

Social awareness program on disaster preparedness was organized by the Ministry of Internal Affairs and Law (MoIAL) Bagmati province at a school in Madi Municipality (Chitwan district) on 18th February. This program focussed on disaster preparedness at local level focusing primarily on firefighting techniques to minimize potential fire-risk. A total of 300 plus students attended the program that left a significant awareness on preparedness measures for fire emergencies. The NHSRP Bagmati team joined MoIAL Bagmati to facilitate the program among the students group.



UPDATES FROM GANDAKI

Capacity building insights in using Reconstruction MIS was laid by the NHSRP province team for the release of second and third tranches of disaster affected beneficiaries to Modi RM, Madi RM and Vyas Municipality. Similar technical insights were continued in all concerned Palikas of Gandaki province. Further, to enhance capacities and assure the effectiveness of NDRRMA's Reconstruction Guideline and RMIS, a physical orientation session for the DRR focal person of Madi RM was organized on 22 February following the request from the local government. Similarly, coordination efforts were initiated with the Ministry of Physical Infrastructure Development (MoPID), Gandaki province, for undertaking housing assessment initiatives in Kaski.

UPDATES FROM LUMBINI

Technical insights for release of reconstruction tranche was provided for release of the first tranche of the reconstruction grant to 19 beneficiaries affected by disasters in Rolpa district. The NHSRP province team meticulously coordinated with the DAO Rolpa and three local levels (Thabang RM, Madi RM, and Tribeni Municipality) of Rolpa district to document beneficiary information comprehensively. Furthermore, in response to requests from the respective district offices, the Ministry of Home Affairs Lumbini Province Fund Mobilization Committee decided to disburse all three tranches of Mandavi RM (Pyuthan) for 24 beneficiaries and 19 beneficiaries from Nisdi RM (Palpa). The NHSRP province team has consistently provided extensive technical support to the provincial ministry, ensuring effective assistance throughout the process.

UPDATES FROM KOSHI

Capacity building assistance in the enrollment of beneficiaries and the subsequent release of reconstruction tranches were forwarded in local levels namely Sahidbhumi RM, Sangurigadhi RM, Maiwakhola RM, and Yangbarak RM of Koshi province. Additionally, the NHSRP team actively engaged in coordinating efforts to establish partnerships with like-minded stakeholders in the housing and settlements sector in the Koshi province. Stakeholder mapping was also conducted to identify key collaborators and partners in the region.

UPDATES FROM MADHESH

Survey of fire-affected houses was undertaken through insightful technical support continued by the NHSRP Madhesh team to strengthen the capacities of IT Officer and DRR focal person of Kalaiya Sub Metropolitan City (Bara district) for the use of Bipad Portal and Reconstruction MIS, along with creation of surveyors' ID. The team jointly conducted a survey of fire-affected homes in Ward 3 (Gangapur) and Ward 27 (Rampur) in Kalaiya, utilizing NDRRMA's Bipad Survey Apps. In the aftermath of the devastating



fires of January 2024 that ravaged 2 homes in local ward areas, the team conducted a thorough survey, determining the extent of damage and identifying affected households from 12th-13th February. Following the survey, each household was allocated a unique identification number (Nissa Number). The survey was conducted under the supervision of the respective ward chairpersons, ensuring transparency and efficiency in the process.

UPDATES FROM SUDURPASCHIM

Capacity strengthening support in enrollment of disaster-affected beneficiaries was provided by conducting the orientation on the Temporary Shelter Construction Guideline and assisting with the documentation, verification, and assessment processes for households affected by monsoon/fire disasters in the region, with MoIAL Sudurpaschim province. Furthermore, support was extended to MoIAL to disburse the first tranche of funds for earthquake affected transitional shelter beneficiaries in Achham, Baitadi, Bajura, Bajhang, Darchula, Doti, Dadeldhura, and Kanchanpur districts. Notably, Dadeldhura district has successfully completed the construction of temporary shelters for all enrolled households.

UPDATES FROM KARNALI

Technical Training rolled out in Jajarkot district on “Transitional Shelter Construction Guideline, Grant Distribution Process, Building Damage Grade Identification and Geo-hazard Assessment” by involving a total of 78 attendees (all engineers/sub-engineers) of all earthquakes affected local bodies of Jajarkot. Three trainings were conducted, spanning over 1.5 days and divided into involving corresponding Palikas, from 4th to 9th February. The training focused on enhancing technical capacities of all technical staff on pertinent measures of- NDRRMA's temporary shelter guidelines, building back better, and on housing recovery and reconstruction. The training was organized by the District Administration Office-Jajarkot jointly supported by Save the Children Nepal, Habitat for Humanity Nepal, NEEDS Nepal and NHSRP.

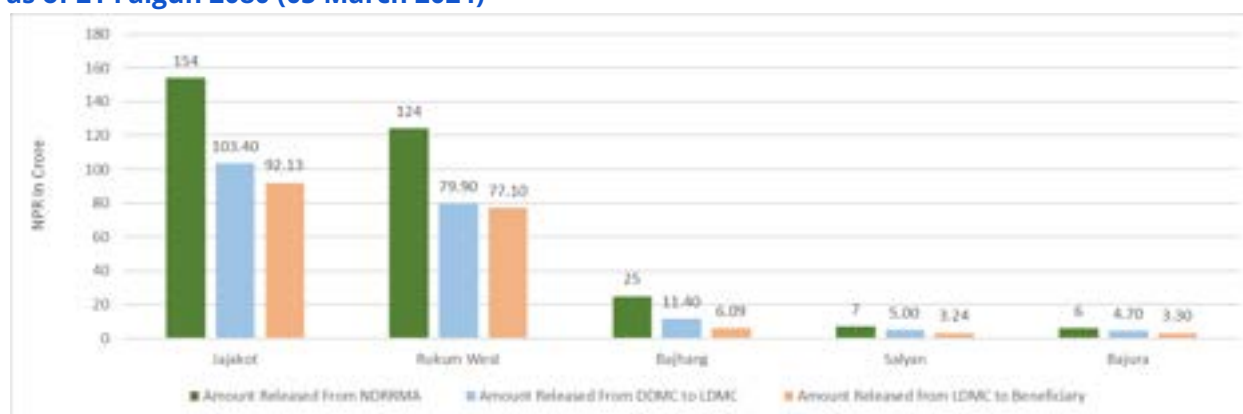


During technical training in Jajarkot areas, the NHSRP team organized a demo session to digitize earthquake beneficiaries' information within the NDRRMA's transitional shelter MIS in Bheri Municipality. The demo session reflections supported Bheri Municipality to make a decision on requesting technical assistance from partners like NRCS, to accelerate the digitization process. NHSRP conducted a session on transitional shelter MIS during each training, introducing the MIS system to all seven municipalities. Participants suggested simplifying the process by utilizing offline systems like Kobo for data collection where internet access is limited. Link: [Report of field visit in Jajarkot by NHSRP](#)

Monitoring of temporary shelter construction was done in three Palikas (Shivalaya RM, Junichade RM and Chedagadh Municipality) from 26th-29th February by the NHSRP Jajarkot response team. Besides monitoring, the orientation on utilizing NDRRMA's Bipad Portal for data entry of beneficiaries was also provided to Ward Secretaries, concerned Palika officials and to the technical staff where issues and challenges of temporary shelter construction were discussed among all participants in the orientation. Similarly, capacity building insights on data entry of temporary shelter beneficiaries into the NDRRMA's Bipad Portal was laid to the frontline technical team of Bheri Municipality in Jajarkot district.

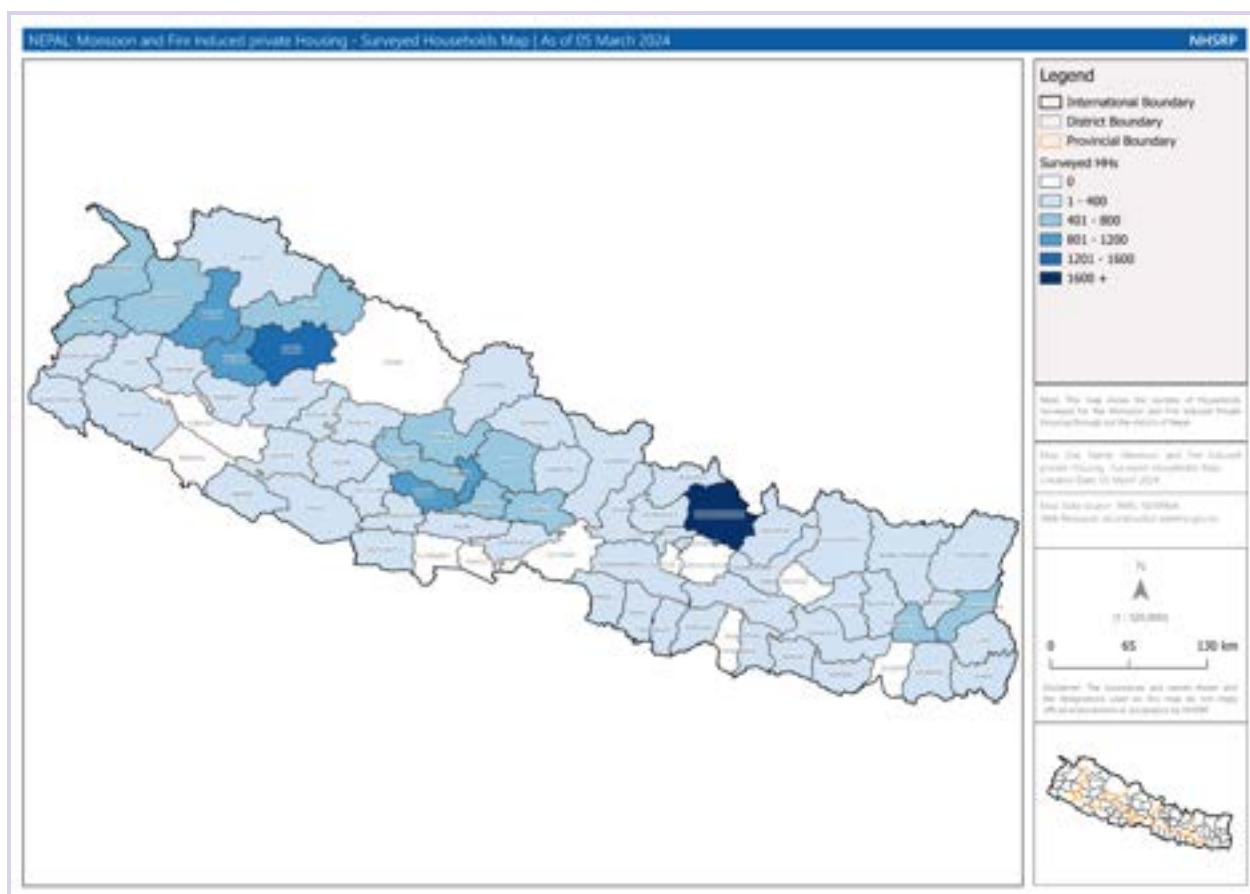
PUBLICATIONS - NDRRMA

Jajarkot Earthquake Response: Progress of NDRRMA Temporary Shelter Grant Disbursement as of 21 Falgun 2080 (05 March 2024)

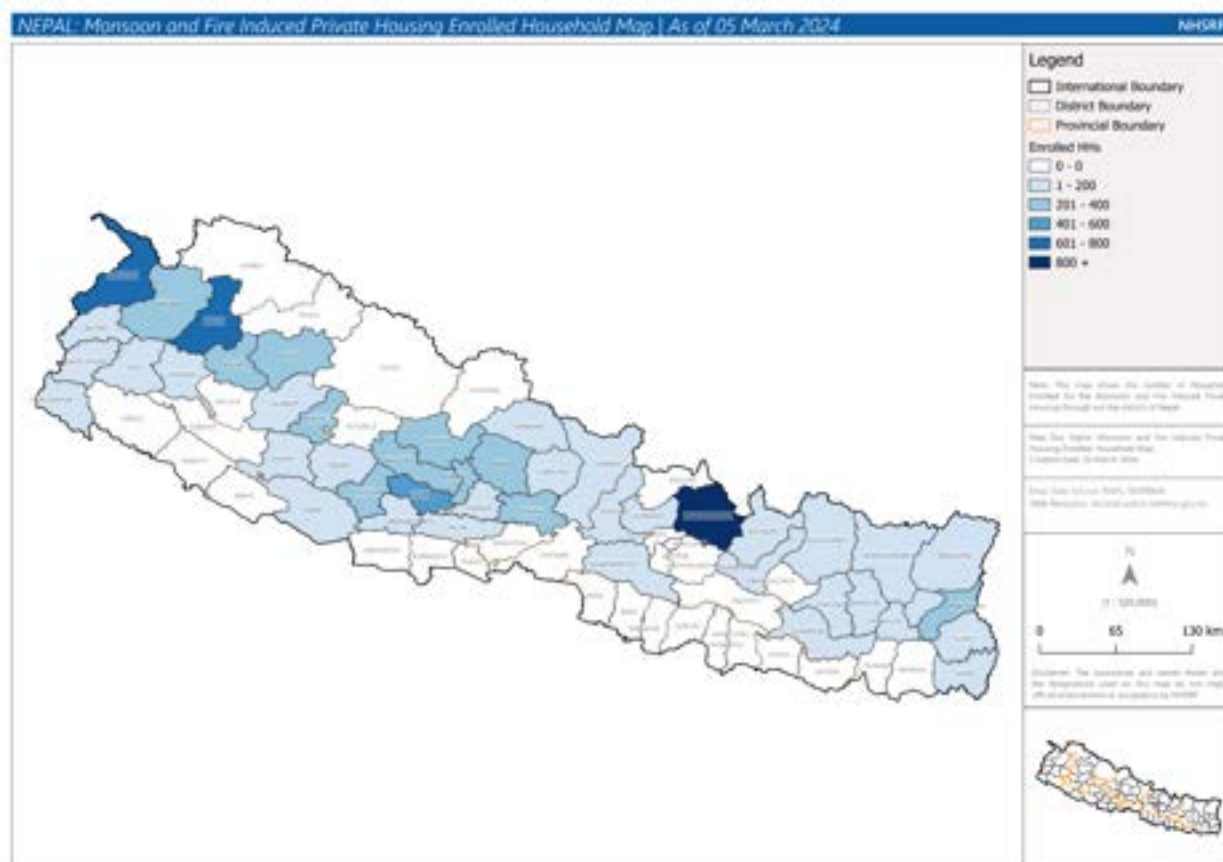


NHSRP PRODUCTS -MAPS

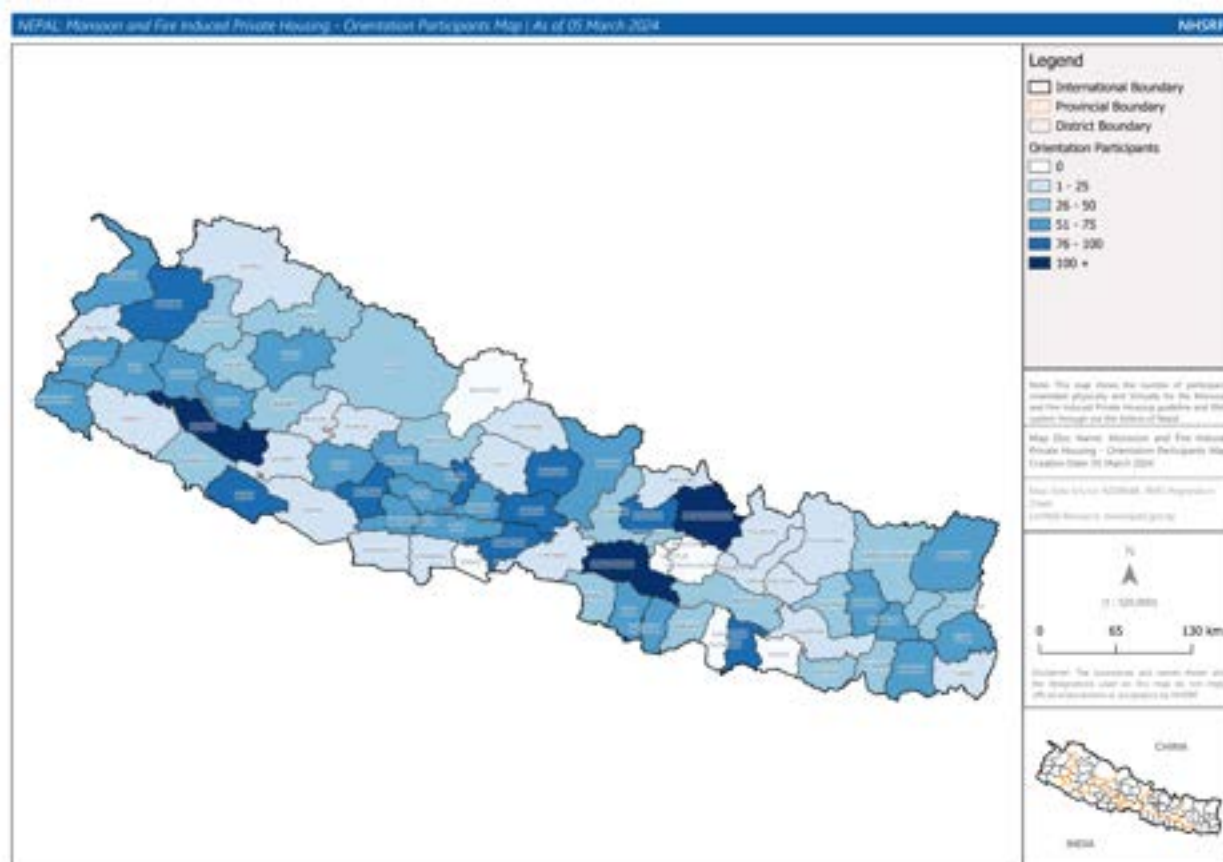
Surveyed Households of Monsoon and Fire Induced Private Housing Reconstruction (05 March 2024):



Enrolled households progress for Monsoon and Fire Induced Private Housing Reconstruction (05 March 2024)



Participants of Physical and Virtual Orientation on Monsoon/Fire-Induced Private Housing Reconstruction Guideline, along with RMIS and Kobocollect (05 March 2024):



KNOW MORE PLATFORM

****NHSRP GRID Podcast****

The NHSRP conducted a podcast conversation with [Mr. Chiribabu Maharjan, Mayor of Lalitpur Metropolitan City](#) (Lalitpur district) held on 23rd February. Several elements of urban environment pertaining to green solutions to climate change adaptation, community development, roles of local governments, future collaborations with like-minded agencies were discussed comprehensively during the podcast. All **seven** episodes of the GRID Podcast are available on NHSRP YouTube Channel: <https://www.youtube.com/@nhsrpnepal/podcasts>



****Call for 3rd Cohort of Climate Fellowship Grant****

[Youth Innovation Lab](#) is accepting applications for the 3rd cohort of the Climate Fellowship Grant of Nepali Yuwa in Climate Action and Green Growth project. Project Area: Nine Municipalities and Province Ministry of Sudurpashchim Province
Know more: <https://theyouthcan.org/climate-fellowship>.
Submit online application: https://bit.ly/climate_fellowship_2024 by 10 March 2023.
For queries: fellowship@youthinnovationlab.org



****Idea call for Innovation Grant 2024****

Do you have any sustainable or innovative ideas that can address social, environmental, and climate challenges? Here's a great opportunity! CREASION Nepal in coordination with its consortium lead [Youth Innovation Lab](#) and partners [Restless Development Nepal](#) and [Center for Disaster Management Studies](#) is calling for applications from Climate Smart Ideators, Entrepreneurs, and Businesses in the Sudurpaschim Province. Youths of Sudurpaschim Province aged between 18-29 are eligible to apply!

To apply: Visit:

<https://theyouthcan.org/climate-smart-entrepreneurship>

Deadline: 20 May 2024



****Free Courses on Shelter and Settlements****

This free course by InterAction and USAID/OFDA provides an overview of the humanitarian community's shelter and settlements activities and examines trends based on past experiences. More here www.disasterready.org



IMPORTANT LINKS

Follow, Like and Subscribe: <https://www.facebook.com/NDRRMA>, <https://youtube.com/NDRRMA>, bipad.gov.np/np, [Daily BIPAD Bulletin of NDRRMA](http://DailyBIPADBulletinofNDRRMA)

Access: [UNDRR's upcoming calendar of events](#)

Access: [Compiled Report Incidents of Monsoon-induced disaster 2079](#)

Access: [Monsoon Preparedness and Response Plan 2079 Government of Nepal](#)

Access: [Monsoon Preparedness and Response Plan 2080 Government of Nepal](#)

Access: [Flood Forecasting and Early Warning Report 2078 Government of Nepal](#)

Access: [Nepal's Position Paper in GPDRR2022](#)

Access: [Proceeding Report-National Dialogue on Anticipatory Action April 2022](#)

Access: [DRRM Localization Trainings, Processes, Results, Lesson Learned and Way Forward](#)

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<http://drrportal.gov.np/>, <http://www.neoc.gov.np/en/>, <http://www.mfd.gov.np/>

Know: DRR Platform Nepal: <https://www.facebook.com/groups/108006329650>
<http://disasterjournalism.com/>, <https://www.undrr.org/>

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